

prudent man sees danger and takes refuge, but the simple keep going and suffer for it” (Proverbs 22:3).

Too often Christians limit their faith in God only to the unseen things, such as salvation; but I happen to believe that God manifests Himself in material ways to those who trust Him. And I do believe God wants to support strongly those who love and trust Him, just as a parent does a loving and obedient child. After all, that is what the Lord told us: “If you, then, though you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give good gifts to those who ask him!”(Matthew 7:11).

A CAR

The second most common source of debt is the purchase of a new car. Quite often a couple who can't qualify to buy a home springs for a new car as a compromise. Unfortunately, it's not a good compromise because cars now sell for prices that houses sold for a few decades ago. This is the major debt trap for most singles who overspend.

Most people are so prone to debt-buying today that they don't even ask the price of a car—just how much the monthly payments are. I believe the automotive industry understands this mentality very well. When they want to stimulate sales for a product that has been inflated out of proportion to most other consumer products, they advertise low interest rates as the biggest selling feature. Usually that is the deciding factor for a generation that has been raised on new cars and nice houses. To the young couple already in debt because of a home that is too expensive, a new car appears to be an answer to their used car problems. So they trade in the old car, which costs money every month to keep running, for a new car with a greater monthly payment (plus gas, oil, and upkeep). But it's not good economics, as they will discover in about two months (the first month is usually free).

A family seeking to sell an almost new car to relieve debt is usually shocked to discover how little it's worth on the open market.